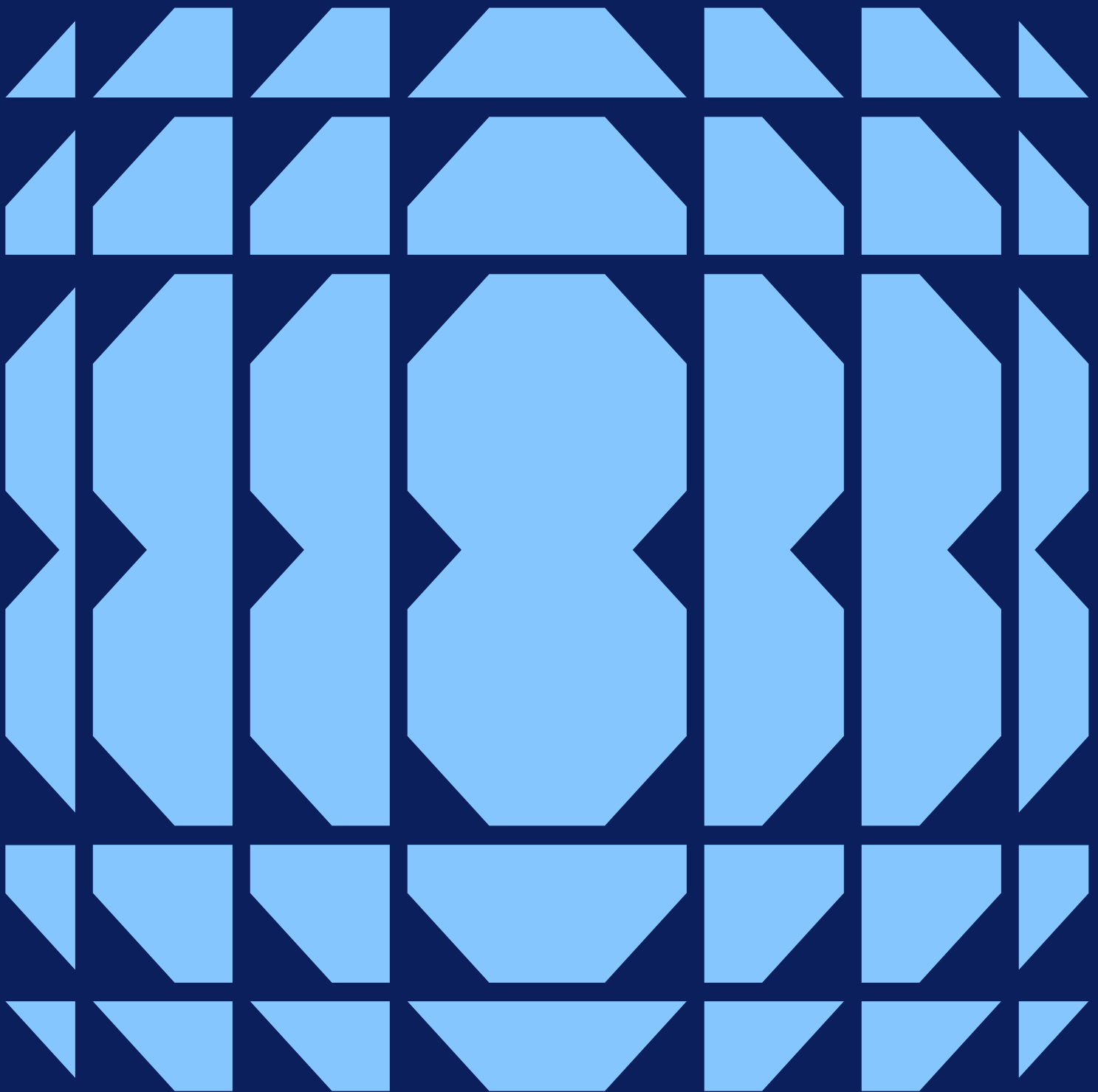




Building a Better Website: Questions Every Business Owner Should Ask



The five-step-process

A successful website project moves through five clear stages. Each stage helps you make better decisions without getting lost in jargon or guesswork. This guide is for small business owners who want to ask the right questions at the right time, so the result is a site that is easy to use, fast to load, and effective at generating enquiries.

Use this ebook during reviews and workshops. Keep the focus on your visitors and your business goals. If a section does not help people take the next step, simplify it or move it. By following the five stages and asking these questions, you will reach launch with confidence and a website that works.

The five stages we will cover:

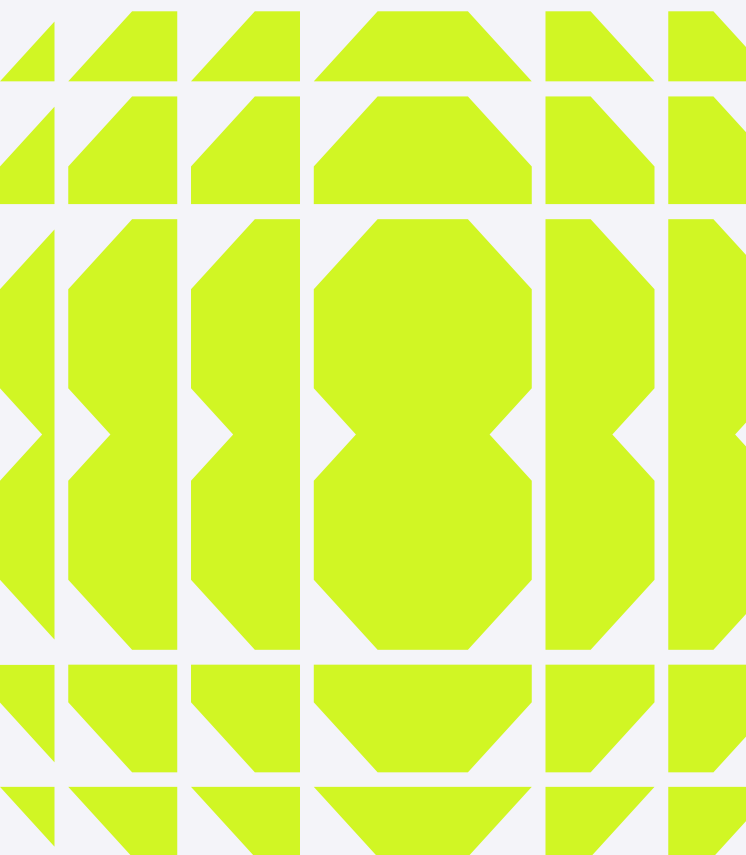
01 Reviewing the sitemap

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Reviewing the sitemap

The sitemap is the blueprint of your website. It maps out the key pages, their purpose, and how visitors will move between them. A clear sitemap sets the foundation for everything that follows.

1. Clarity

- What is the key thing you want visitors to do before they leave the website?
 - 👉 Is it to buy something, call or email you, or to learn something new?
- How well does the sitemap reflect the true goals of the business and the needs of its audience?
 - 👉 Is it easy for users to find what they are looking for and do the key action?
- Is the purpose of the website clearly supported by the way the content is structured?
 - 👉 Do page titles, text, and buttons guide people to that key action?

2. User journey and navigation

- Does the sitemap guide different types of users towards their goals in a logical way?
 - 👉 Would new and returning visitors know what you want them to do?
- Are we making it easy for visitors to find what matters most to them?
 - 👉 Is it really clear and easy to find the most important information?

3. Content structure and page purpose

- Have we made thoughtful decisions about what deserves its own page?
 - 👉 Should any pages be split or merged?
- Are we providing enough depth without making the site feel cluttered?
 - 👉 Have we missed anything by keeping the site too small?

Reviewing wireframes

Wireframes show the layout of each page before design is added. They help you see the flow of content, user journeys, and priorities, ensuring the site structure supports your goals.

1. Strategic purpose

- Does the layout reflect the main goals of the site?

 What do you want visitors to do before they leave, and is that clear?

- Are core services positioned where users will see them?

 Is it obvious what your business does?

- Is the value proposition visible within a few seconds on the Home page?

 Is the main message clear within a few seconds?

2. User experience and journey

- Does the layout guide users to the next step get in touch, explore services, sign up?

 Do the most obvious buttons and links take you to the most important page?

- Is anything included that could distract or slow people down?

 Does anything pull attention away from the end goal?

3. Structure and content hierarchy

- Does the wireframe show a clear order of headline, supporting text, and a call to action?

 Do sections have a clear title, short paragraph, and something to click?

- Are important elements given enough visual weight?

 Do buttons, links, and key stats stand out?

- Where will attention naturally fall, and is that effective?

 Where are your eyes drawn, and is that the right area?

Reviewing the mockups

Mockups bring design and brand to life. At this stage you check colours, images, and tone to confirm the site reflects your identity while guiding visitors towards clear actions.

1. Visual design and aesthetic

- How well does the visual design express the brand and set you apart?

 What makes it clear this site is yours and not a competitor?

- How does the visual hierarchy guide people to key actions?

 How does the page guide visitors to the main action?

- Do the visuals support immediate appeal and long term usability?

 Will it still look good when content changes?

2. Usability and clarity

- Can users understand each page without help?

 Could anyone move around the site without guidance?

- Does the design minimise friction across the journey?

 Could someone with low IT skills still succeed?

- How does it support different levels of digital fluency?

 Could someone with low IT skills still succeed?

3. Brand and tone of voice

- Does the design reflect the right personality and values?

 Do colour, images, and text show what makes you better?

- Do visuals and copy reinforce your positioning and values?

 Do any pages look or feel out of place and why?

Reviewing a prototype

The prototype is a working version of your site. It lets you test navigation, interactions, and content in context so you can spot any issues before development begins.

1. Overall experience and strategic fit

- Does the prototype bring the full experience to life in support of your goals?

 Does the site meet your minimum requirements?

- How well does it deliver the core experience you intended?

 Are visitors guided to key actions like contacting you or buying?

- How effectively does it guide different user types to their goals?

 Which assumptions about user behaviour should we test?

2. Flow and navigation

- Can users move smoothly and find what they need?

 Can you move around easily or get stuck anywhere?

- Where does momentum break down?

 Are any actions or paths unclear and need a tweak?

3. Responsiveness and device experience

- Does it look and work well on desktop, tablet, and mobile?

 Is the mobile and desktop experience equally strong?

- Where might smaller screens cause friction or compromise?

 Are any sections less easy to use on mobile?

- Are device specific opportunities under used?

 Could touch, location, or gestures be used more effectively?

Getting ready to launch

The sitemap is the blueprint of your website. It maps out the key pages, their purpose, and how visitors will move between them. A clear sitemap sets the foundation for everything that follows.

1. Final review of pages

- Read every page. Check for spelling and grammar issues, missing or incorrect images, and outdated information.

 Confirm all key pages are included such as Home, About, Services, and Contact.

2. Mobile and tablet view

- Open the site on your phone and tablet.

 Are you happy with how it looks and works on these devices?

3. Test all links and buttons

- Click every button and link, including menus and social icons.

 Do they all work? Have you checked that every button goes to the expected location?

4. Review contact details

- Confirm your phone number, email, and address are correct.

 Send a test message through the contact form and check the result.

5. Check social media links

- Check that all links go to the correct accounts?

 Do they open in a new tab?

Want to get in touch?

If you want to find out more about 80five and how we can help you create an unforgettable website for your business, you can find out more on our website, call us, or drop us an email.



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